

**EXHIBIT** **3.6** Major Motivation Theories

**CLASSIFICATION OF  
MOTIVATION THEORIES**

1. *Content motivation theories* focus on explaining and predicting behavior based on employee need motivation.
2. *Process motivation theories* focus on understanding how employees choose behaviors to fulfill their needs.
3. *Reinforcement theory* proposes that behavior can be explained, predicted, and controlled through the consequences for behavior.

**SPECIFIC MOTIVATION THEORY**

- A. *Hierarchy of needs theory* proposes that employees are motivated through five levels of need—physiological, safety, social, esteem, and self-actualization.
- B. *Two-factor theory* proposes that employees are motivated by motivators (higher-level needs) rather than maintenance (lower-level needs) factors.
- C. *Acquired needs theory* proposes that employees are motivated by their need for achievement, power, and affiliation.
- A. *Equity theory* proposes that employees will be motivated when their perceived inputs equal outputs.
- B. *Expectancy theory* proposes that employees are motivated when they believe they can accomplish the task, they will be rewarded, and the rewards for doing so are worth the effort.
- C. *Goal-setting theory* proposes that achievable but difficult goals motivate employees.
- Types of Reinforcement
  - Positive
  - Avoidance
  - Extinction
  - Punishment

organization for another to meet this need.<sup>43</sup> The key to successful leadership is to meet the needs of employees while achieving organizational objectives.<sup>44</sup>

## Hierarchy of Needs Theory

In the 1940s, Abraham Maslow developed his hierarchy of needs theory,<sup>45</sup> which is based on four major assumptions: (1) Only unmet needs motivate. (2) People's needs are arranged in order of importance (hierarchy) going from basic to complex needs. (3) People will not be motivated to satisfy a higher-level need unless the lower-level need(s) has been at least minimally satisfied. (4) Maslow assumed that people have five classifications of needs, which are presented here in hierarchical order from low to high level of need.

### Hierarchy of Needs

The **hierarchy of needs theory** proposes that people are motivated through five levels of needs—physiological, safety, belongingness, esteem, and self-actualization:

1. *Physiological needs*: These are people's primary or basic needs: air, food, shelter, sex, and relief from or avoidance of pain.
2. *Safety needs*: Once the physiological needs are met, the individual is concerned with safety and security.
3. *Belongingness needs*: After establishing safety, people look for love, friendship, acceptance, and affection. Belongingness is also called *social needs*.

4. *Esteem needs:* After the social needs are met, the individual focuses on ego, status, self-respect, recognition for accomplishments, and a feeling of self-confidence and prestige.
5. *Self-actualization needs:* The highest level of need is to develop one's full potential. To do so, one seeks growth, achievement, and advancement.

Maslow's hierarchy of needs is commonly taught in psychology and business courses,<sup>46</sup> because it offers a very rich theory of human motivation and its determinants at the individual level.<sup>47</sup> However, Maslow's work was criticized because it did not take into consideration that people can be at different levels of needs based on different aspects of their lives. Nor did he mention that people can revert back to lower-level needs. Today, Maslow's followers and others realize that needs are not on a simple five-step hierarchy. Maslow's assumptions have recently been updated to reflect this insight, and many organizations today are using a variety of the management methods he proposed 30 years ago. Maslow has also been credited with influencing many management authors, including Douglas McGregor, Rensis Likert, and Peter Drucker.

### Motivating Employees with Hierarchy of Needs Theory

The major recommendation to leaders is to meet employees' lower-level needs so that they will not dominate the employees' motivational process. You should get to know and understand people's needs and meet them as a means of increasing performance. It is important to build self-esteem.<sup>48</sup> See Exhibit 3.7 for a list of ways in which managers attempt to meet these five needs.

#### Work Application 4

On what level of the hierarchy of needs are you at this time for a specific aspect of your life (professional or personal)? Be sure to specify the level by name, and explain why you are at that level.

### Opening Case APPLICATION

#### 3-a. How does Market America meet its distributors' content motivation needs?

Market America allows people to climb the *hierarchy of needs* as distributors: earn money (*physiological*), with minimum risk (*safety*), through customer contact and meetings (*social*), through the job itself with unlimited growth potential (*esteem*), and be the boss, which allows control over their job and time (*self-actualization*).

### Two-Factor Theory

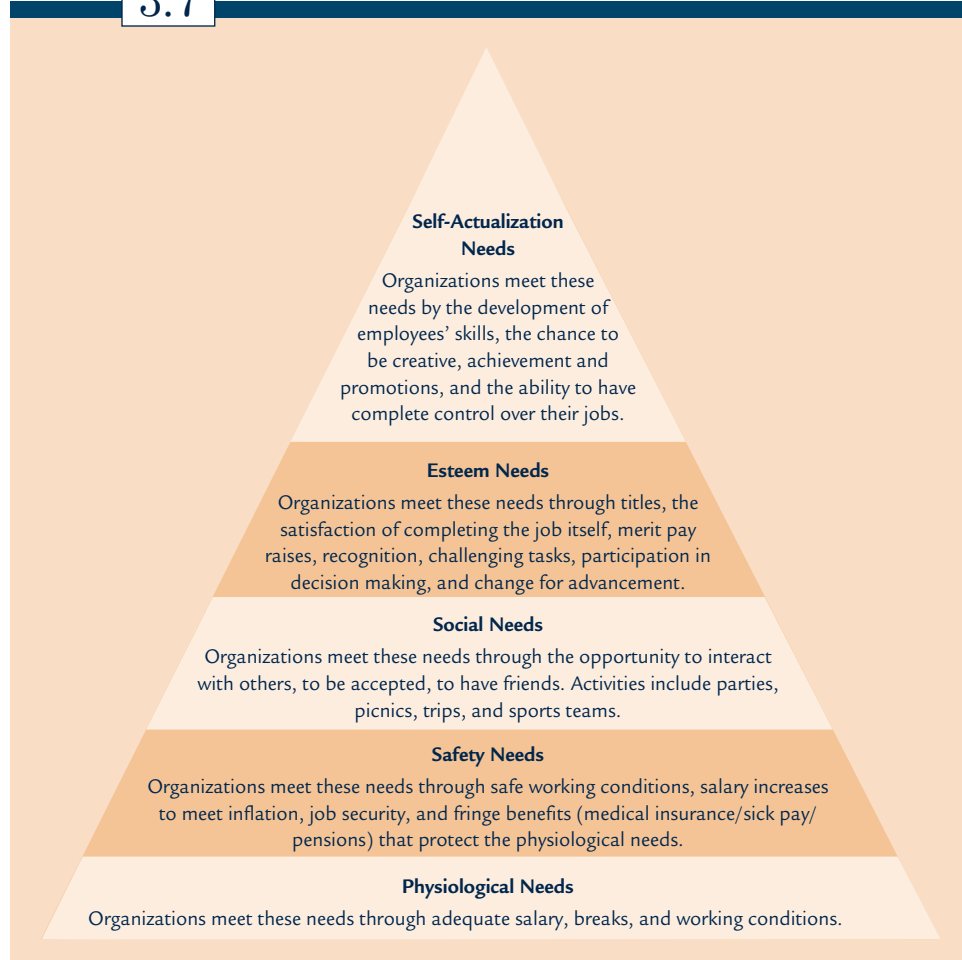
In the 1960s, Frederick Herzberg published his two-factor theory.<sup>49</sup> Herzberg combined lower-level needs into one classification he called *hygiene* or *maintenance*; and higher-level needs into one classification he called *motivators*. The **two-factor theory** proposes that people are motivated by motivators rather than maintenance factors. Before you learn about two-factor theory, complete Self-Assessment 3.

#### Maintenance—Extrinsic Factors

Maintenance factors are also called *extrinsic motivators* because motivation comes from outside the person and the job itself. Extrinsic motivators include pay, job security, and title; working conditions; fringe benefits; and relationships. These factors are related to meeting lower-level needs. Review Self-Assessment 3, the even-numbered questions, for a list of extrinsic job factors.

#### Motivators—Intrinsic Factors

Motivators are called *intrinsic motivators* because motivation comes from within the person through the work itself. Intrinsic motivators include achievement, recognition, challenge, and advancement. These factors are related to meeting higher-level needs, and are better at motivating than extrinsic factors.<sup>50</sup> Doing something we want to do and doing it well can be its own reward. Review Self-Assessment 3, the odd-numbered questions, for a list of intrinsic job factors.

**EXHIBIT 3.7** How Organizations Motivate with Hierarchy of Needs Theory**SELF-ASSESSMENT 3****Job Motivators and Maintenance Factors**

Here are 12 job factors that contribute to job satisfaction. Rate each according to how important it is to you by placing a number from 1 to 5 on the line before each factor.

Very important                      Somewhat important                      Not important  
5                      4                      3                      2                      1

- |                                                                                       |                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| _____ 1. An interesting job I enjoy doing                                             | _____ 5. The opportunity for advancement                                            |
| _____ 2. A boss who treats everyone the same regardless of the circumstances          | _____ 6. A nice title regardless of pay                                             |
| _____ 3. Getting praise and other recognition and appreciation for the work that I do | _____ 7. Job responsibility that gives me freedom to do things my way               |
| _____ 4. A job that is routine without much change from day-to-day                    | _____ 8. Good working conditions (safe environment, cafeteria, etc.)                |
|                                                                                       | _____ 9. The opportunity to learn new things                                        |
|                                                                                       | _____ 10. An emphasis on following the rules, regulations, procedures, and policies |
|                                                                                       | _____ 11. A job I can do well and succeed at                                        |
|                                                                                       | _____ 12. Job security; a career with one company                                   |

*continued*

## Managing Conflict

---

A **conflict** exists whenever people are in disagreement and opposition. Conflict is inevitable because people don't see things exactly the same way.<sup>39</sup> An organization's success is based on how well it deals with conflicts.<sup>40</sup> In this section we discuss the psychological contract, conflict and leadership, and the five conflict management styles you can use to resolve conflicts.

### The Psychological Contract

All human relations rely on the psychological contract.<sup>41</sup> The *psychological contract* is the unwritten implicit expectations of each party in a relationship. At work, you have a set of expectations of what you will contribute to the organization (effort, time, skills) and what it will provide to you (compensation, job satisfaction, and so on). We are often not aware of our expectations until they have not been met (for example, how you are treated by your manager).<sup>42</sup>

### Conflict Arises by Breaking the Psychological Contract

The psychological contract is broken for two primary reasons: (1) We fail to make explicit our own expectations and fail to inquire into the expectations of the other parties. (2) We further assume that the other party(ies) has the same expectations that we hold. So as long as people meet our expectations, everything is fine; when they don't meet our expectations, we are in conflict. Thus, it is important to share information and negotiate expectations assertively.<sup>43</sup> After all, how can you expect others to meet your expectations when they don't know what they are?

### Conflict and Leadership

Many leaders are constantly exposed to conflict. Executives say their managers spend an average of more than seven hours a week sorting out conflicts among their staff members.<sup>44</sup> Thus, handling conflict constructively is an important leadership skill.<sup>45</sup> Your ability to resolve conflicts will have a direct effect on your leadership success. With the trend toward teamwork, conflict skills are increasingly important to team decision making.<sup>46</sup> In the global economy, you need to be sensitive to cultural differences so that you don't create additional conflicts.<sup>47</sup>

### Conflict Can Be Dysfunctional or Functional

People often think of conflict as fighting and view it as disruptive. When conflict is not resolved effectively, negative consequences occur.<sup>48</sup> When conflict prevents the achievement of organizational objectives, it is negative or *dysfunctional conflict*. However, it can be positive. *Functional conflict* exists when disagreement and opposition supports the achievement of organizational objectives. Functional conflict increases the quality of group decisions and leads to innovative changes.<sup>49</sup> The question today is not whether conflict is negative or positive, but how to manage conflict to benefit the organization.

**Learning Outcome 7** Define the five conflict management styles.

---

## Conflict Management Styles

Conflict management skills can be developed with appropriate training. In this discussion, we focus on resolving conflicts in your own personal and professional life.

When you are in conflict, you have five conflict management styles to choose from. The five styles are based on two dimensions of concern: concern for others' needs and concern for your own needs. These concerns result in three types of behavior:

1. A low concern for your own needs and a high concern for others' needs results in passive behavior.
2. A high concern for your own needs and a low concern for others' needs results in aggressive behavior.
3. A moderate or high concern for your own needs and others' needs results in assertive behavior.

Each conflict style of behavior results in a different combination of win-lose situations. The five styles, along with concern for needs and win-lose combinations, are presented in Exhibit 6.4 and discussed here in order of passive, aggressive, and assertive behavior. The conflict style that you tend to use the most is based on your personality and leadership style. There is no one best conflict management style for all situations. In this section you will learn the advantages and disadvantages and the appropriate use of each conflict management style.

#### EXHIBIT 6.4 Conflict Management Styles



### Avoiding Conflict Style

The *avoiding conflict style* user attempts to passively ignore the conflict rather than resolve it. When you avoid a conflict, you are being unassertive and uncooperative. People avoid conflict by refusing to take a stance, or escape conflict by mentally withdrawing and physically leaving. A lose-lose situation is created because the conflict is not resolved.

**Advantages and Disadvantages of the Avoiding Conflict Style** The advantage of the avoiding style is that it may maintain relationships that would be hurt through conflict resolution. The disadvantage of this style is that conflicts do not get resolved. An overuse of this style leads to conflict within the individual.

People tend to walk all over the avoider. Some managers allow employees to break rules without confronting them. Avoiding problems usually does not make them go away; the problems usually get worse. And the longer you wait to confront others, the more difficult the confrontation usually is.<sup>50</sup>

***Appropriate Use of the Avoiding Conflict Style*** The avoiding style is appropriate to use when (1) the conflict is trivial; (2) your stake in the issue is not high; (3) confrontation will damage an important relationship; (4) you don't have time to resolve the conflict; or (5) emotions are high. When you don't have time to resolve the conflict or people are emotional, you should confront the person(s) later. However, it is inappropriate to repeatedly avoid confrontation until you get so upset that you end up yelling at the other person(s). This passive-aggressive behavior tends to make the situation worse by hurting human relations. Often people do not realize they are doing something that bothers you (that you are in conflict), and when approached properly, they are willing to change.

### **Accommodating Conflict Style**

The *accommodating conflict style* user attempts to resolve the conflict by passively giving in to the other party. When you use the accommodating style, you are being unassertive but cooperative. You attempt to satisfy the other party, neglecting your own needs by letting others get their own way. A win-lose situation is created, as you try to please everyone.

***Differences Between the Avoiding and Accommodating Styles*** A common difference between the avoiding and accommodating styles is based on behavior. With the avoiding style, you don't have to do anything you really did not want to do; with the accommodating style, you do. For example, if you are talking to someone who makes a statement that you disagree with, to avoid a conflict you can say nothing, change the subject, or stop the conversation. However, suppose you have to put up a display with someone who says, "Let's put up the display this way." If you don't want to do it the other person's way, but say nothing and put it up the other person's way, you have done something you really did not want to do.

### ***Advantages and Disadvantages of the Accommodating Conflict Style***

The advantage of the accommodating style is that relationships are maintained by doing things the other person's way. The disadvantage is that giving in may be counterproductive. The accommodating person may have a better solution, such as a better way to put up a display. An overuse of this style tends to lead to people taking advantage of the accommodator, and the type of relationship the accommodator tries to maintain is usually lost.

***Appropriate Use of the Accommodating Conflict Style*** The accommodating style is appropriate when (1) the person enjoys being a follower; (2) maintaining the relationship outweighs all other considerations; (3) the changes agreed to are not important to the accommodator, but are to the other party; or (4) the time to resolve the conflict is limited. This is often the only style that can be used with an autocratic manager who uses the forcing style.

### **Forcing Conflict Style**

The *forcing conflict style* user attempts to resolve the conflict by using aggressive behavior to get his or her own way. When you use the forcing style, you are uncooperative and aggressive, doing whatever it takes to satisfy your own needs—at the expense of others, if necessary. Forcers use authority, threaten, intimidate, and call

for majority rule when they know they will win. Forcers commonly enjoy dealing with avoiders and accommodators. If you try to get others to change without being willing to change yourself, regardless of the means, then you use the forcing style. A win-lose situation is created.

***Advantages and Disadvantages of the Forcing Style*** The advantage of the forcing style is that better organizational decisions will be made, when the forcer is correct, rather than less-effective compromised decisions. The disadvantage is that overuse of this style leads to hostility and resentment toward its user. Forcers tend to have poor human relations.

***Appropriate Use of the Forcing Style*** Some managers commonly use their position power to force others to do what they want them to do. The forcing style is appropriate to use when (1) unpopular action must be taken on important issues; (2) commitment by others to proposed action is not crucial to its implementation—in other words, people will not resist doing what you want them to do; (3) maintaining relationships is not critical; or (4) the conflict resolution is urgent.

### Negotiating Conflict Style

The *negotiating conflict style* user attempts to resolve the conflict through assertive, give-and-take concessions. This is also called the *compromising style*. When you use the compromising approach, you are moderate in assertiveness and cooperation. An “I win some, you win some” situation is created through compromise. As discussed in Chapter 4, negotiation skills are important in both your personal and your professional life.<sup>51</sup>

***Advantages and Disadvantages of the Negotiating Conflict Style*** The advantage of the negotiating style is that the conflict is resolved relatively quickly and working relationships are maintained. The disadvantage is that the compromise often leads to counterproductive results, such as suboptimum decisions. An overuse of this style leads to people playing games such as asking for twice as much as they need in order to get what they want. It is commonly used during management and labor collective bargaining.

***Appropriate Use of the Negotiating Conflict Style*** The negotiating style is appropriate to use when (1) the issues are complex and critical, and there is no simple and clear solution; (2) parties have about equal power and are interested in different solutions; (3) a solution will be only temporary; or (4) time is short.

### Collaborating Conflict Style

The *collaborating conflict style* user assertively attempts to jointly resolve the conflict with the best solution agreeable to all parties. It is also called the *problem-solving style*. When you use the collaborating approach, you are being assertive and cooperative. Although avoiders and accommodators are concerned about others’ needs, and forcers are concerned about their own needs, the collaborator is concerned about finding the best solution to the problem that is satisfactory to all parties. Unlike the forcer, the collaborator is willing to change if a better solution is presented. While negotiating is often based on secret information, collaboration is based on open and honest communication. This is the only style that creates a true win-win situation.

***Differences Between the Negotiating and Collaborating Styles*** A common difference between negotiating and collaborating is the solution. Let’s



continue with the example of putting up a display. With negotiation, the two people may trade off by putting up one display one person's way and the next display the other person's way. This way they each win and lose. With collaboration, the two people work together to develop one display method that they both like. It may be a combination of both, or simply one person's idea if after an explanation, the other person really agrees that the method is better. The key to collaboration is agreeing that the solution is the best possible one.

### Work Application 9

Select a present or past manager. Which conflict management style did that manager use most often? Explain by giving a typical example. Which one of the five conflict management styles do you tend to use most often? Explain your answer.

---



---



---



---

**Advantages and Disadvantages of the Collaborating Style** The advantage of the collaborating style is that it tends to lead to the best solution to the conflict, using assertive behavior. The disadvantage is that the skill, effort, and time it takes to resolve the conflict are usually greater and longer than the other styles. There are situations, mentioned under "Negotiating Conflict Style," when collaboration is difficult, and when a forcer prevents its use. The collaborating style offers the most benefit to the individual, group, and organization.

### Applying the Concept 3

#### Selecting Conflict Management Styles

For each of these five conflict situations, identify the most appropriate conflict management style. Write the appropriate letter in the blank before each item.

- |                  |                |                  |
|------------------|----------------|------------------|
| a. avoiding      | c. forcing     | e. collaborating |
| b. accommodating | d. negotiating |                  |
- \_\_\_\_\_ 16. You have joined a committee in order to meet people. Your interest in what the committee does is low. While serving on the committee, you make a recommendation that is opposed by another member. You realize that you have the better idea. The other party is using a forcing style.
  - \_\_\_\_\_ 17. You are on a task force that has to select a new computer. The four alternatives will all do the job. It's the brand, price, and service that people disagree on.
  - \_\_\_\_\_ 18. You are a sales manager. Beth, one of your competent salespeople, is trying to close a big sale. The two of you are discussing the next sales call she will make. You disagree on the strategy to use to close the sale.
  - \_\_\_\_\_ 19. You're late and on your way to an important meeting. As you leave your office, at the other end of the work area you see Chris, one of your employees, goofing off instead of working.
  - \_\_\_\_\_ 20. You're over budget for labor this month. It's slow, so you ask Kent, a part-time employee, to leave work early. Kent tells you he doesn't want to go because he needs the money.

**Appropriate Use of the Collaborating Conflict Style** The collaborating style is appropriate when (1) you are dealing with an important issue that requires an optimal solution, and compromise would result in suboptimizing; (2) people are willing to place the group goal before self-interest, and members will truly collaborate; (3) maintaining relationships is important; (4) time is available; and (5) it is a peer conflict.

Of the five styles the most difficult to implement successfully, due to the complexity and level of skill needed, is the collaborative style. It is most likely to be underutilized when it would have been appropriate. Organizations around the globe are training employees to resolve conflicts using collaboration.<sup>52</sup>